Lesson 1 - Jack´s Birthday | Phonemic awareness of the /b/ sound and vocabulary building

Soar in Reading 1

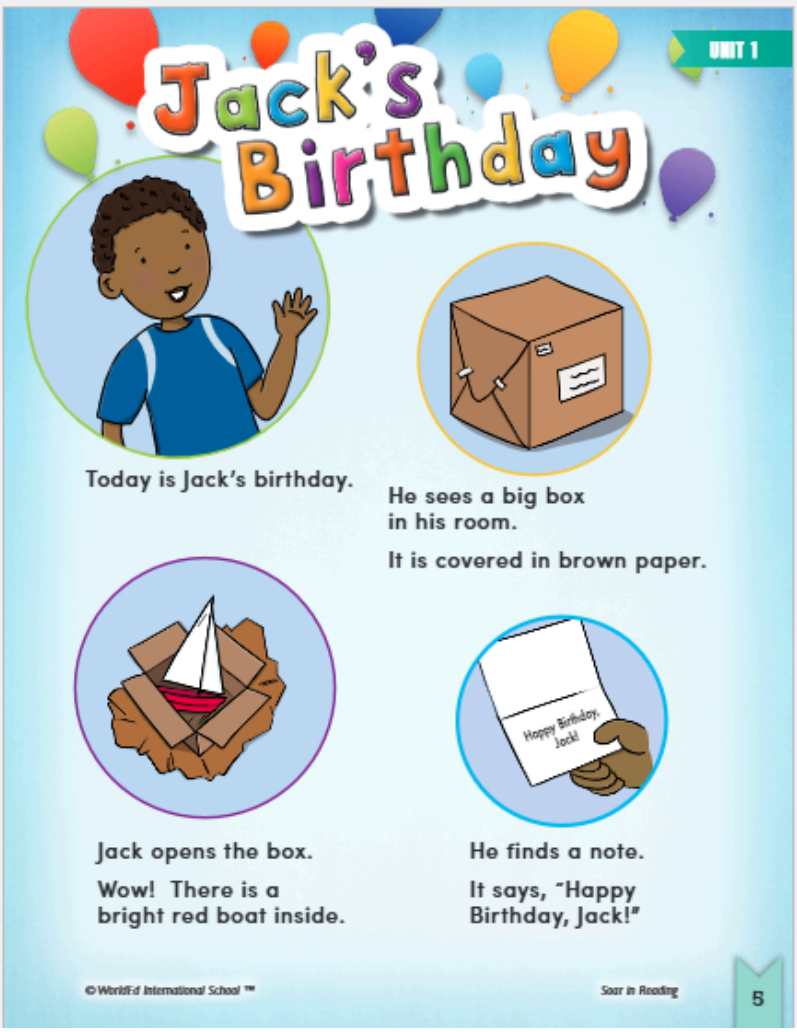
Grade Level: 1

Duration: 40 minutes

Focus: Phonemic awareness of the /b/ sound and vocabulary building

Subject: English Language Arts – Reading

Pages: 5



Unit 1

Lesson Title: Identifying the /b/ Sound and Vocabulary Matching

Standards Alignment

Relevant Standards:

- **ELA-LITERACY.RF.K.2.D:** Isolate and pronounce the initial sounds in spoken words.

- **ELA-LITERACY.RF.K.3.A:** Demonstrate basic knowledge of one-to-one letter-sound correspondences by producing the primary sound for each consonant.

Lesson Objectives

By the end of this lesson, students will:

- Identify words that begin with the /b/ sound and differentiate them from other sounds.
- Match vocabulary words to their corresponding images.
- Develop confidence in associating phonics with visual representation.

Materials Needed

For the Teacher:

- A large picture of a ball for the hook activity
- Flashcards or digital projections of images (e.g., ball, bird, car, bus, apple)
- A box wrapped in brown paper for the “What’s in the Box?” game
- Small objects or printed pictures to place in the box (e.g., ball, book, apple, car)
- Chart paper and markers for modeling vocabulary
- Page 5 of the student workbook for reference

For the Students:

- Crayons or colored pencils (enough for each student)
- Pencils for writing activities
- Student workbooks with Page 5 accessible
- Pencils

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1. Presentation (5-10 minutes)

***Objective**: Introduce the /b/ sound and the concept of matching words to pictures.*

Hook

A. Show a large picture of a ball.
B. Ask students, “What sound does this word start with? Can you say it with me?”
C. Encourage students to repeat the /b/ sound as a group and individually.

Introduce the Concept:

A. Explain that the /b/ sound is the first sound in words like “ball,” “boat,” and “bird.” Emphasize the /b/ sound and model how to pronounce it:
B. Place your lips together to form a seal.
C. Push air out of your mouth, creating a small explosion of sound.
D. Demonstrate this action slowly and ask students to mirror you.
E. Say each example word slowly and have students repeat after you, focusing on the /b/ sound.” Emphasize the /b/ sound and demonstrate how to pronounce it by exaggerating the lip movement.

Demonstrate

A. Display three images: ball, cat, and book.
B. Say each word aloud and ask students to identify which starts with the /b/ sound.
C. Write the words on the board, underlining the first letter, and emphasize the /b/ in words that begin with this sound.

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2. Warm-Up Activity (5–7 minutes)

Objective: *Activate prior knowledge of sounds and introduce vocabulary.*

Activity Instructions:

- Display pictures (e.g., bat, car, bus, apple) one at a time.
- Tell students, “If the word starts with the /b/ sound, clap your hands. If it does not, remain quiet.”

- Provide immediate feedback and model the correct response when needed.

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3. Practice (5-10 minutes)

Objective: *Guide students in structured practice identifying the /b/ sound, matching words to images, and building vocabulary comprehension.*

Instructions:

- Project Page 5 of the workbook and display the story text: *Today is Jack's birthday. He sees a big box in his room. Jack opens the box. Wow! There is a bright red boat inside. He finds a note. It says, "Happy Birthday, Jack!" It is covered in brown paper.*
- Read the story aloud to the students, pausing to emphasize vocabulary words (e.g., "box," "room," "boat," "paper") and ensuring they understand the meaning of each.
- While reading the story, ask comprehension questions about the story to check understanding. Examples:

  "Whose birthday is it today?"

  "What does Jack find in the box?"

  "What is the box covered with?"

Explain: "Now, you will circle the words that start with the /b/ sound.."

Model reading the b word, like "birthday", then ask students to repeat the word after you and circle it.

Monitor student work and provide support as needed.

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4. Production (10-15 minutes)

***Objective**: Allow students to demonstrate understanding through independent work.*

Instructions:

- Provide students with blank paper and tell them you will dictate 3 words. Then tell them they will draw only the ones that begin with the /b/ sound. Say each word at a time, repeat the same word twice, give them time to draw, write the word on the board, then go to the next word.
- After students draw, ask them to label their pictures by copying the word from the board. Say: “Write the word for your picture under it. If you need my help, raise your hand.”
- Display student drawings on the board or wall for a gallery walk.

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5. Reading for Success Activity (10–15 minutes)

***Objective**: Reinforce phonemic awareness and vocabulary comprehension through a creative and interactive activity.*

Activity Instructions:

Game Title: "What's in the Box?"

Set up: Bring a box wrapped in brown paper (like the one from the story). Place several small objects or pictures inside—some beginning with the /b/ sound (e.g., ball, book) and others without (e.g., apple, car).

Student Task:

A. Students will take turns reaching into the box without looking and pulling out an object or picture.
B. The student will name the object, identify if it starts with the /b/ sound, and say the word aloud.
C. If the object starts with /b/, they keep it in their pile; if not, it goes back into the box.

D. Continue until all objects are sorted. End with a discussion about the /b/ sound and the objects that start with it.

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6. Differentiation by Readiness

For Struggling Learners:

- During the warm-up activity, provide struggling learners with visual aids and gestures to support understanding. For example, point to the /b/ sound image and say the word slowly.
- During practice, work with a small group to guide them through the activity. Use verbal prompts like, “Does this start with /b/ or another sound?”
- Provide additional time for the vocabulary matching task and offer examples they can refer to on the board.
- Pair struggling learners with a peer buddy during the production activity to provide assistance with drawing and labeling.

For Advanced Learners:

- Challenge advanced learners to brainstorm five new words starting with the /b/ sound during the presentation phase and share them with the class.
- During practice, ask them to create sentences using at least two of the matched vocabulary words (e.g., “The box is in the room”).
- Encourage them to enhance their drawings in the production activity by adding detailed labels or a short story about their /b/ object.
- In the Reading for Success activity, ask advanced learners to call out their own /b/ words for the bingo game, fostering peer interaction and creativity.
- Challenge students to think of additional words that begin with the /b/ sound.
- Ask them to write a short sentence or story using at least three /b/ words.

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7. Wrap-Up and Reflection (5-10 minutes)

Objective: Summarize the lesson and encourage reflection.

- **Review Key points:**

Ask students, “What words did we learn today that start with the /b/ sound?” Write responses on the board.

- **Reflect:**

Invite students to share their drawings and one new thing they learned about the /b/ sound. Encourage positive feedback and celebrate their effort.

Why This Lesson Works

1. **Engagement:** Includes interactive activities like clapping, drawing, and playing bingo to maintain interest.
2. **Learning Goals:** Each activity directly supports the learning objectives. The warm-up introduces the sound, practice activities build phonemic awareness, and the production phase reinforces understanding through creative application.
3. **Structure:** Starting with teacher-led demonstrations in the presentation phase ensures students grasp the /b/ sound. Guided practice solidifies this understanding, and independent production allows students to demonstrate their learning creatively.
4. **Differentiation:** Provides tailored support for struggling and advanced learners to ensure everyone succeeds.